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Honjo et al.

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(54) **WORK MACHINE AND MOBILE CRANE**

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CPC **B66C 23/74** (2013.01); **B66C 13/00**
(2013.01); **B66C 23/88** (2013.01); **B66C 23/36**
(2013.01); **B66C 2700/0371** (2013.01)

(58) **Field of Classification Search**

CPC B66C 23/72; B66C 23/74; B66C 23/76;
E02F 9/18; B62D 49/085

See application file for complete search history.

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Primary Examiner — Anna M Momper

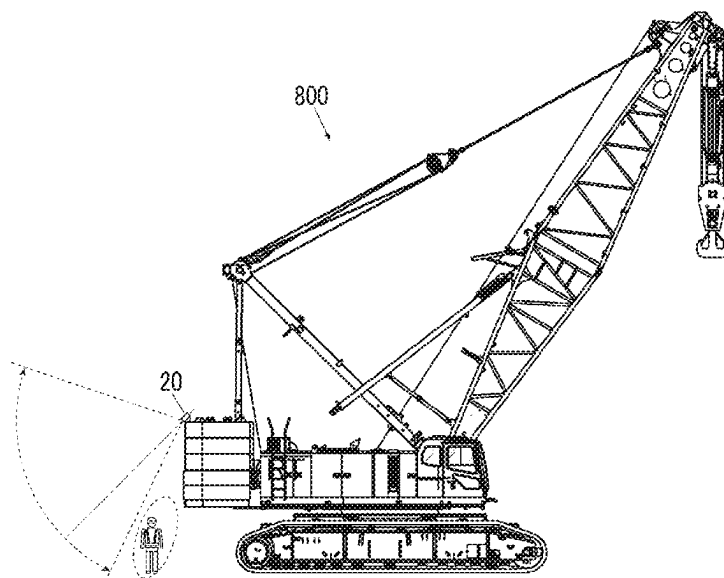
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Friedrich LLP

(57) **ABSTRACT**

The work machine includes a work machine body, and an
assembly component that is attached to the work machine
body. The work machine further includes a detection unit
that monitors surroundings. The work machine body
includes a lower traveling body and a rotating platform that
rotates relative to the lower traveling body. The detection
unit is attached to the rotating platform without interposing
the assembly component.

10 Claims, 7 Drawing Sheets



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FIG. 1

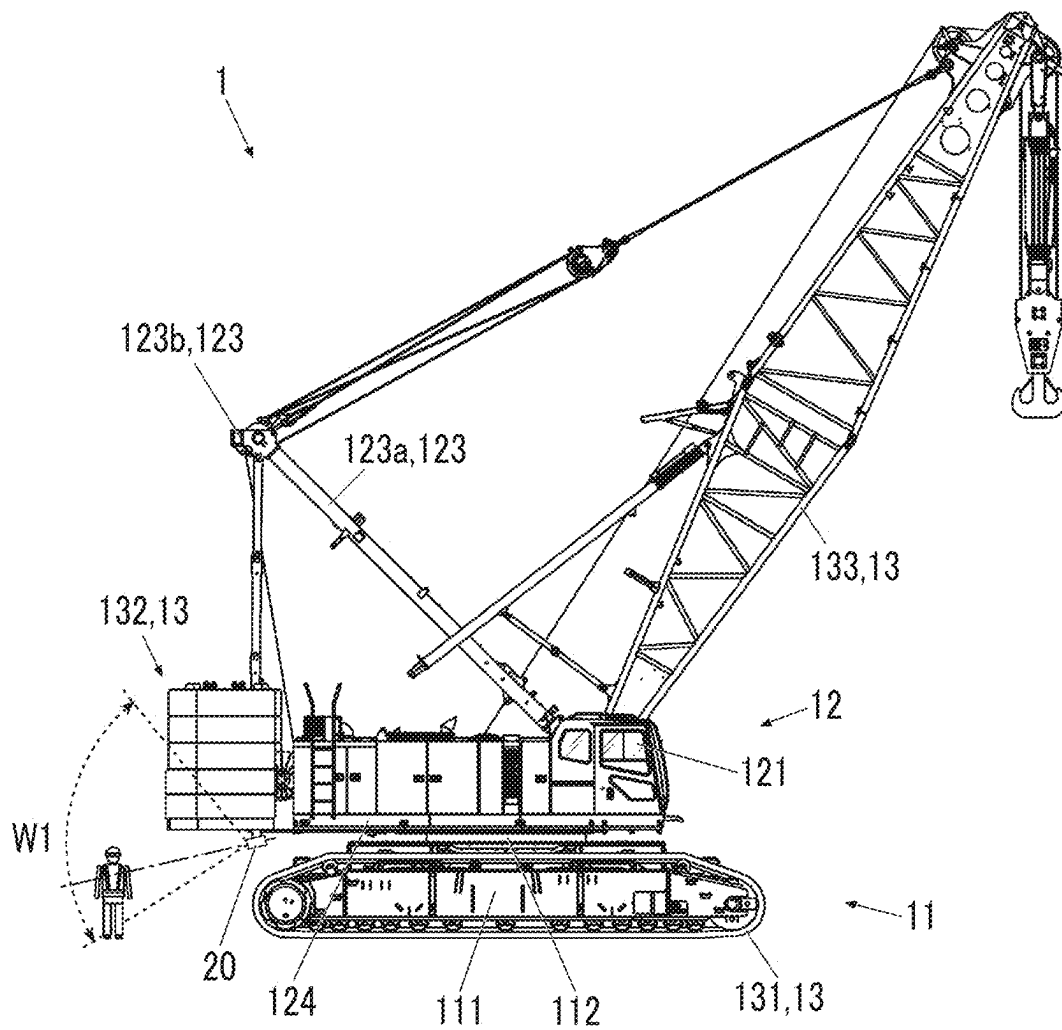


FIG. 2

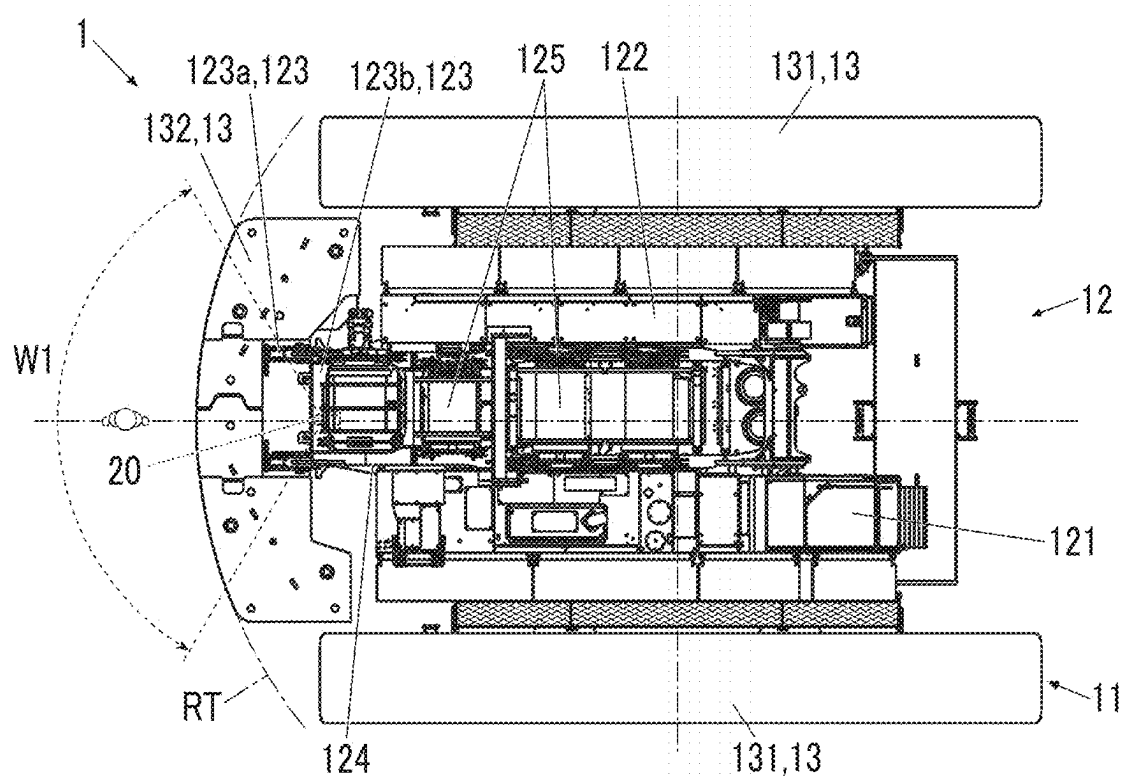


FIG. 3

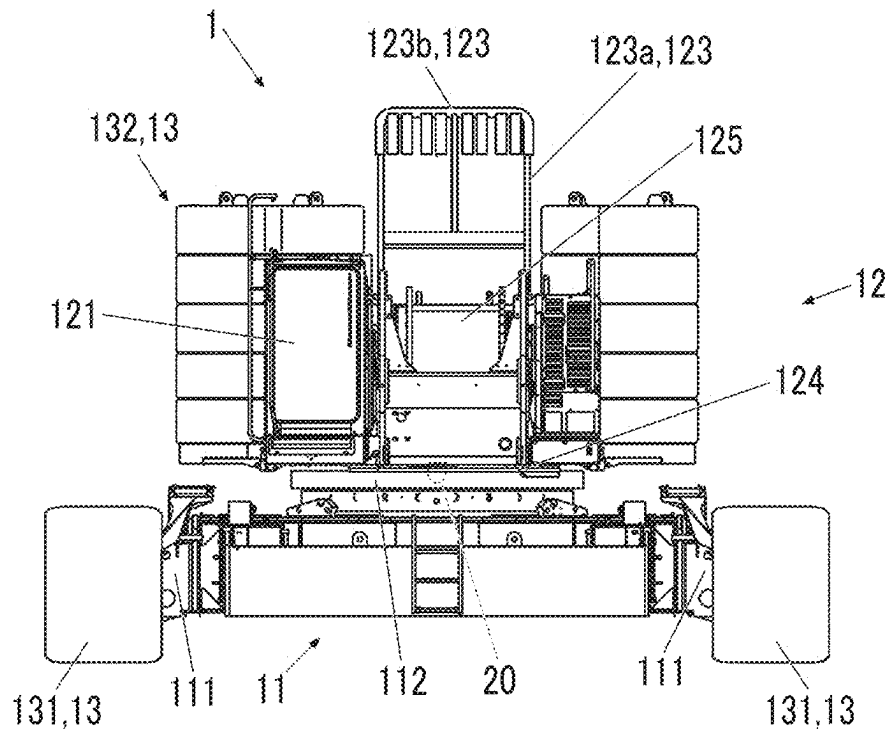


FIG. 4

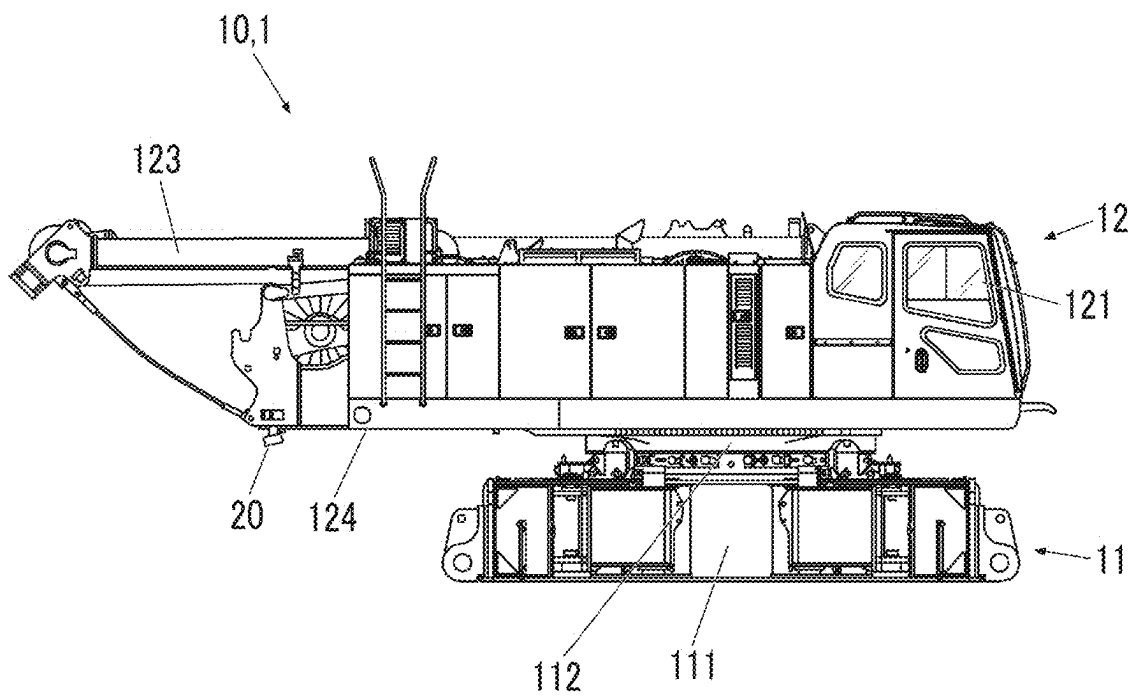


FIG. 5A

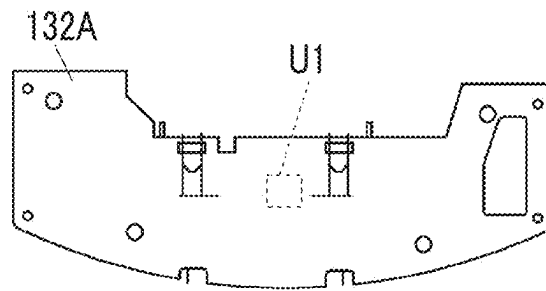


FIG. 5B

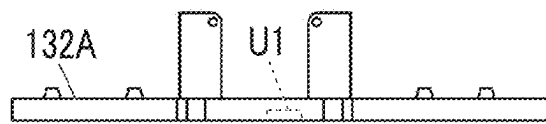


FIG. 5C

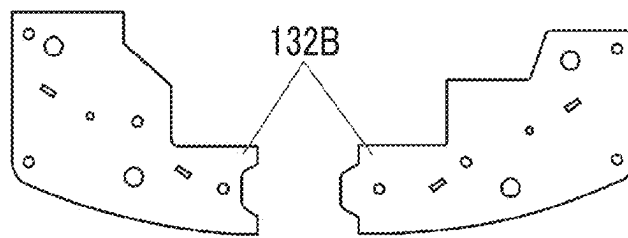


FIG. 5D



FIG. 5E

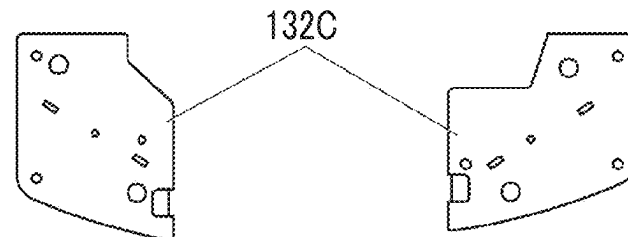


FIG. 5F

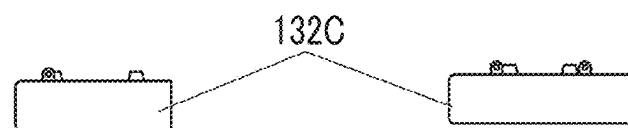


FIG. 6A

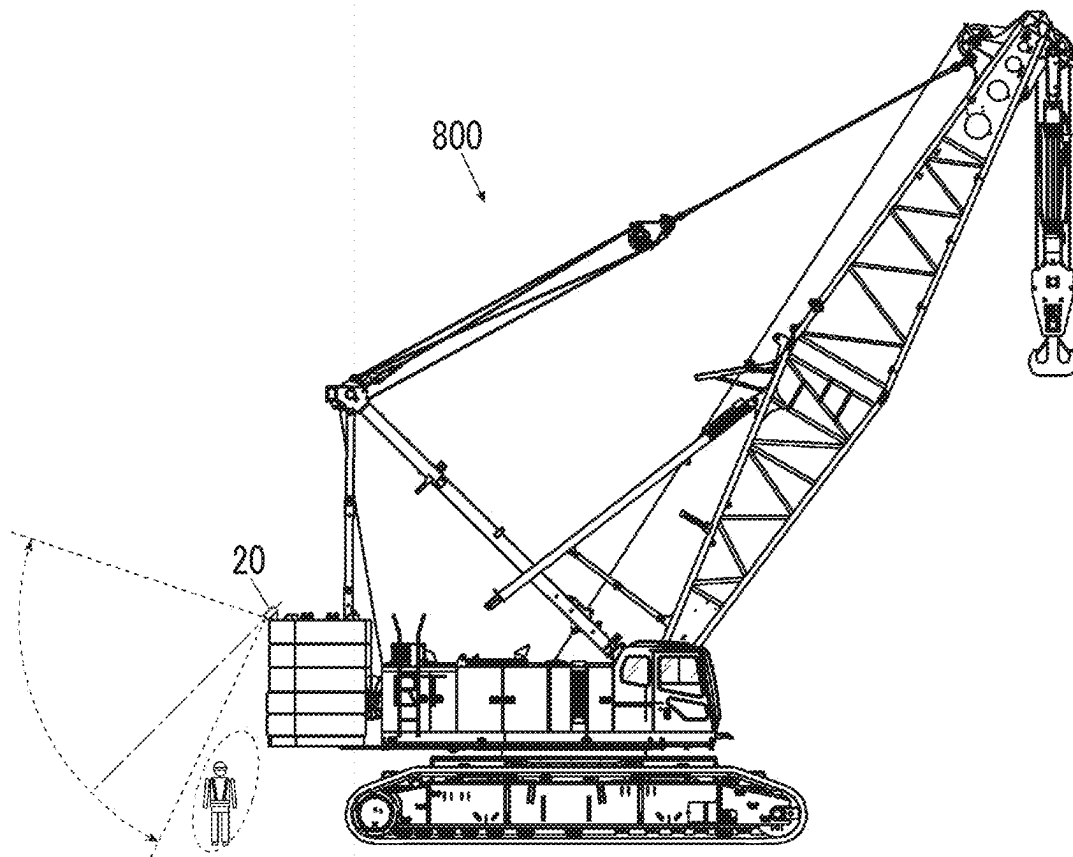


FIG. 6B

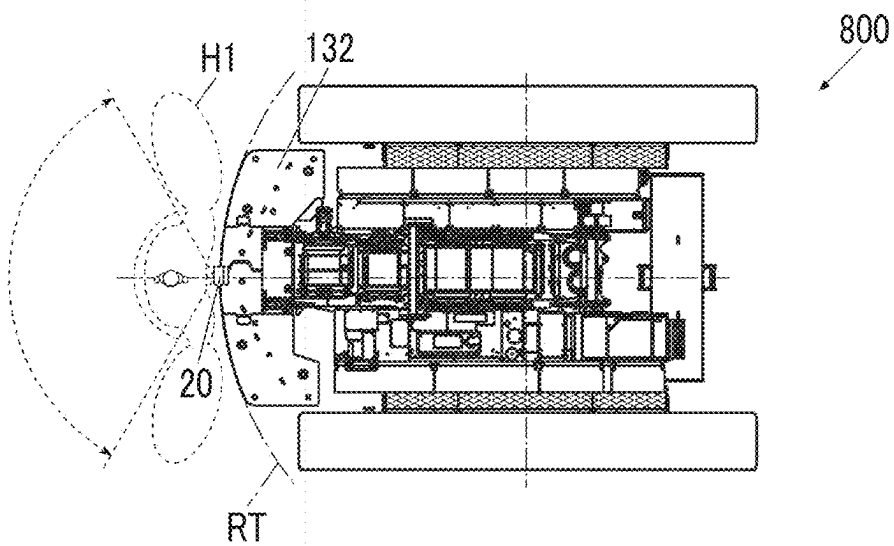


FIG. 7

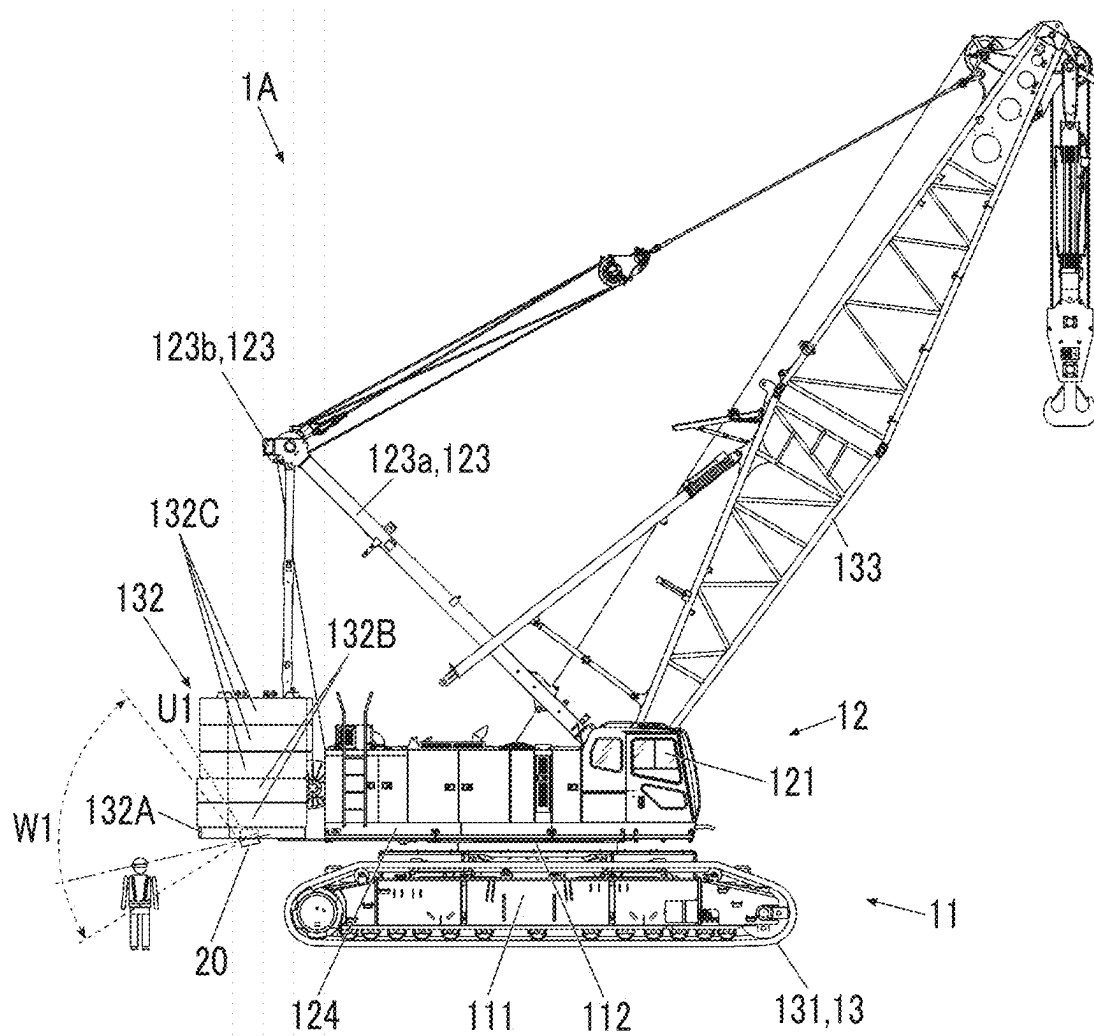
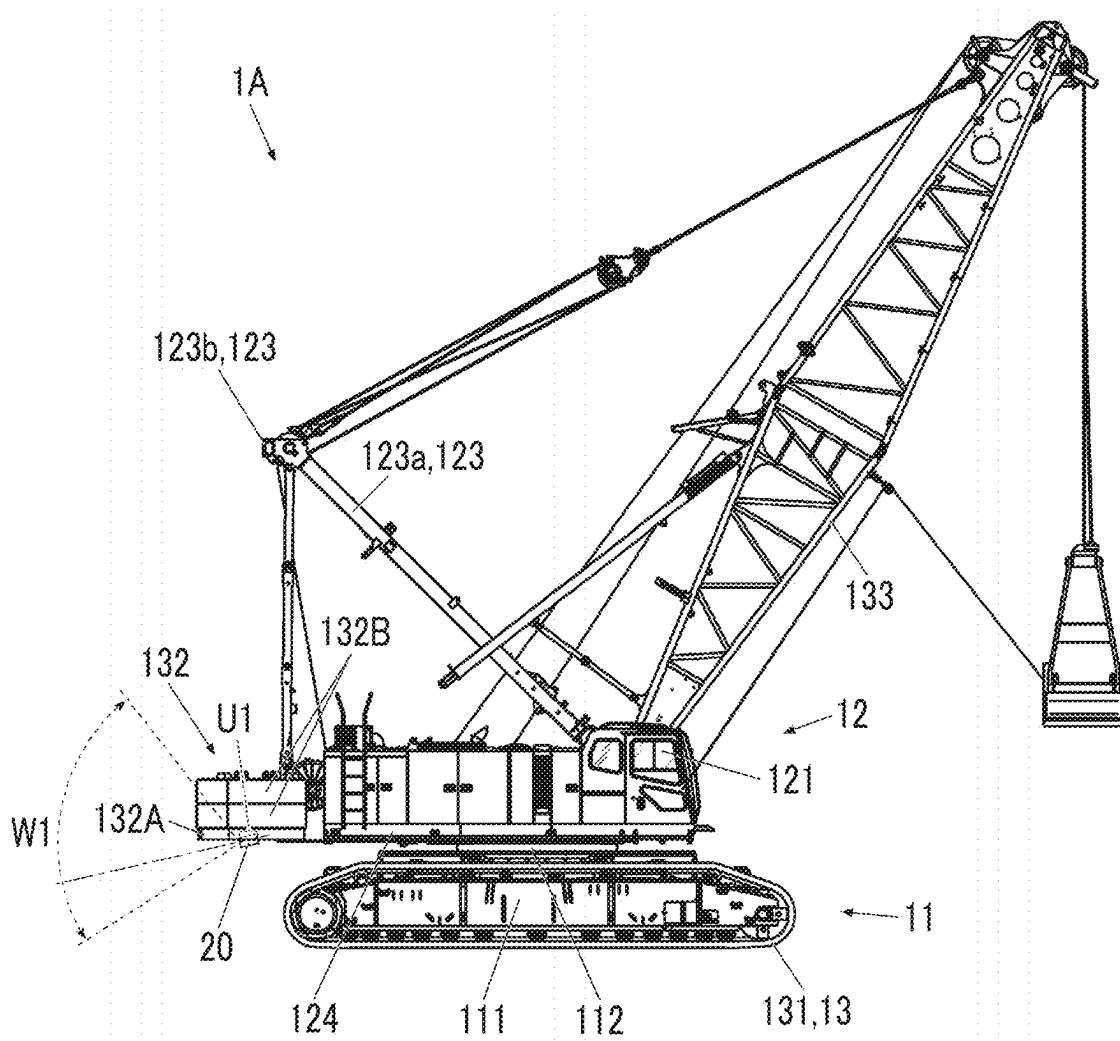


FIG. 8



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WORK MACHINE AND MOBILE CRANE**RELATED APPLICATIONS**

The contents of Japanese Patent Application No. 2020-057213, and of International Patent Application No. PCT/JP2021/012987, on the basis of each of which priority benefits are claimed in an accompanying application data sheet, are in their entirety incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND**Technical Field**

Certain embodiments of the present invention relate to a work machine and a mobile crane.

Description of Related Art

The related art discloses a surrounding monitoring device for an excavator, which is a work machine. The surrounding monitoring device includes a camera and a distance image sensor attached at an upper rear end of a counterweight of the excavator.

SUMMARY

According to an embodiment of the present invention, there is provided a work machine that is assembled or disassembled, the work machine including:

- a work machine body; and
- an assembly component that is attached to the work machine body, the work machine further including:
 - a detection unit that monitors surroundings,
 - in which the work machine body includes a lower traveling body and a rotating platform that rotates relative to the lower traveling body, and
 - the detection unit is attached to the rotating platform without interposing the assembly component.

According to another embodiment of the present invention, there is provided a mobile crane that is assembled or disassembled at a work site, the mobile crane including:

- a crane body; and
- a counterweight that includes weights in a plurality of stages and that is attached to the crane body,
- in which a setting is capable of being changed to any one of a plurality of lifting capacities by changing the number of stages of the weights attached to the crane body, and
- the plurality of lifting capacities includes a first lifting capacity and a second lifting capacity that is a lower lifting capacity than the first lifting capacity,
- the mobile crane further including:
 - a detection unit that monitors surroundings attached to the counterweight,
 - in which the detection unit is attached below an uppermost stage of the weight attached when the second lifting capacity is set.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

FIG. 1 is a side view showing a work machine according to Embodiment 1 of the present invention.

FIG. 2 is a plan view of the work machine illustrating the disposition of a detection unit.

FIG. 3 is a front view of the work machine illustrating the disposition of the detection unit.

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FIG. 4 is a view showing a configuration of the work machine of FIG. 1 with an assembly component removed.

FIG. 5A is a view showing a counterweight and a plan view of a base weight.

FIG. 5B is a view showing the counterweight and a rear view of the base weight.

FIG. 5C is a view showing the counterweight and a plan view of a first weight.

FIG. 5D is a view showing the counterweight and a rear view of the first weight.

FIG. 5E is a view showing the counterweight and a plan view of a second weight.

FIG. 5F is a view showing the counterweight and a rear view of the second weight.

FIG. 6A is a side view showing a work machine of a comparative example.

FIG. 6B is a plan view showing the work machine of the comparative example.

FIG. 7 is a side view showing a state in which a work machine according to Embodiment 2 of the present invention is set to have a first lifting capacity.

FIG. 8 is a side view showing a state in which the work machine according to Embodiment 2 is set to have a second lifting capacity lower than the first lifting capacity.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

A work machine such as a crawler crane is assembled at a work site, and when the work is completed, the work machine is disassembled at the work site and carried out. Moreover, there is an assembly component that may or may not be attached at each site. In the case of the work machine that is assembled or disassembled in this way, it is necessary to change the position of a surrounding monitoring device depending on the mounting situation of the assembly component, and there is a need in that it is difficult to realize uniform monitoring processing is difficult.

It is desirable to provide a work machine and a mobile crane that are assembled or disassembled and that can realize monitoring processing that is less dependent on the mounting situation of an assembly component.

According to the present invention, in the work machine and the mobile crane that are assembled or disassembled at a work site, surrounding monitoring can be performed even during assembly or disassembly without the need to move a surrounding monitoring device.

Hereinafter, respective embodiments of the present invention will be described in detail with reference to the drawings.

Embodiment 1

FIG. 1 is a side view showing a work machine according to Embodiment 1 of the present invention. FIG. 2 is a plan view of the work machine illustrating the disposition of a detection unit. FIG. 3 is a front view of the work machine illustrating the disposition of the detection unit. FIGS. 2 and 3 show a state in which a boom 133 is removed. FIG. 4 is a view showing a configuration of the work machine of FIG. 1 with an assembly component removed. Hereinafter, a description will be made with a direction along a pivot axis of the boom 133 as a left-right direction, and out of directions perpendicular and horizontal to the pivot axis of the boom 133, a cab 121 side from a turning center of the rotating platform 12 is described as a front side and a counterweight 132 side is described as a rear side.

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A work machine **1** according to Embodiment 1 is a machine that is assembled and used at a work site, or disassembled and transported from the work site. The work machine **1** is a mobile crane, specifically a crawler crane. In addition, the assembly or disassembly may be performed at a place for assembly around a place other than where lifting work or the like is actually performed. For example, the work machine **1** may be assembled halfway up a mountain, and the assembled work machine **1** may travel and move to a work place. In this case, the assembly place is halfway up the mountain.

The work machine **1** includes a work machine body (crane body) **10** (see FIG. 4), an assembly component **13** that is lifted by a heavy machine and that is attached to the work machine body **10**, and a detection unit **20** that monitors the surroundings. The work machine body **10** in FIG. 4 shows a state in which the assembly component **13** is not attached. The work machine **1** may further include a monitoring device that receives a detection signal from the detection unit **20** and that monitors the surroundings. The monitoring device may include a display unit that outputs a monitoring image including surrounding workers, pedestrians, or obstacles detected by the detection unit **20**. The display unit may be disposed in a cab of the work machine **1**, a management terminal at the work site, a management center away from the site, or the like.

The work machine body **10** includes a lower traveling body **11** to which a crawler component **131** is assembled to constitute a crawler, and a rotating platform **12** that rotates relative to the lower traveling body **11**. The rotating platform **12** includes a cab **121**, a winch **125**, a hydraulic device **122**, a mast **123**, a main frame **124**, a lower frame **111**, which is a support base for the lower traveling body **11**, and the like. The main frame **124** is a member that supports any one of the boom, the hydraulic device, the winch, or the mast from below. Specifically, the main frame **124** is a frame that supports each component of the rotating platform **12** and to which the boom is pivotably connected, is connected to the lower traveling body **11** via a turning bearing, and extends from the cab **121** to a halfway spot of the counterweight **132** in a front-rear direction. The main frame **124** may be configured so that the main frame **124** can be divided and assembled into a plurality of frames such as a front frame and a back frame. Even in this case, the front frame and the back frame are included in the work machine body **10** and are not included in the assembly component **13**. The work machine body **10** has a jack (not shown) for raising itself. The mast **123** is configured to apply a rearward load to the boom **133**. When the work machine **1** is assembled or disassembled, a hook is hung from a tip of the mast **123**, the assembly component **13** is lifted and lowered by the hook and the rotating platform **12** is turned, so that the assembly component **13** lifted by the mast **123** can be moved. The mast **123** is a concept that includes an A-frame that does not oscillate during crane work.

The assembly component **13** is a part that is mainly assembled at a work site, and means a heavy part that is attachable to the work machine body **10** by being lifted by the heavy machine or the like. Therefore, parts such as a lightweight ladder that can be raised and attached only by human power, parts such as a lightweight stay, and a bracket for attaching a camera are excluded from the assembly component **13**. That is, in the present specification, the "assembly component" is defined as a part that cannot be assembled by human power alone. A part that cannot be assembled by human power alone is a part that needs to be

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lifted by the heavy machine or the like defined in each site or assembly manual, and is, for example, a part larger than 20 kg.

The assembly component **13** includes the crawler component **131**, the counterweight **132**, the boom **133**, a lower weight (not shown), and the like. The crawler component **131** may include a part of a crawler drive mechanism in addition to crawler shoes. The assembly component **13** is connected to the work machine body **10** by pin joints, cylinder fastening, or bolt fastening.

The assembly component **13** is attached at the work site as follows. For example, the crawler component **131** is lifted using another crane or the mast **123** and is moved to the lower frame **111** of the lower traveling body **11** in a state in which the work machine body **10** is raised by the jack. In this state, the worker connects the crawler component **131** to the lower frame of the lower traveling body **11**. The counterweight **132** is lifted using another crane or the mast **123**, moved to a rear portion of the main frame **124**, and attached to a relevant spot. The boom **133** and the lower weights **134** are also lifted using another crane or the mast **123**, moved to an attachment spot of the main frame **124**, and attached to the relevant spot.

FIGS. 5A to 5F are views showing the counterweight, FIGS. 5A, 5C, and 5E show plan views of a base weight, a first weight, and a second weight, respectively, and FIGS. 5B, 5D, and 5F show rear views of the base weight, the first weight, and the second weight, respectively. The counterweight **132** includes a base weight **132A** attached to the main frame of the rotating platform **12**, and a first weight **132B** and a second weight **132C** attached to the rotating platform **12** via the base weight **132A**. The base weight **132A** is configured to be attachable only in one stage, and the first weight **132B** and the second weight **132C** of the same form are configured to be stacked in a plurality of stages and be attachable. The counterweight **132** may be configured such that other weights such as the first weight **132B** and the second weight **132C** are stacked above the base weight **132A** or other weights are suspended below the base weight **132A**.

The detection unit **20** is a device that acquires data for detecting objects present in the surroundings, such as a range finder such as a scanning type light detection and ranging (LiDAR) device or an imaging camera. The detection unit **20** has a detection range W1 shown in FIGS. 1 and 3 and detects an object present within the detection range W1. The detection range W1 extends in an angle range centered on a vertical axis and an angle range centered on an axis extending to the left and right. In a case where the detection unit **20** is a LiDAR device, the detection unit **20** can acquire data indicating the direction and distance of an object located in the detection range and detect where the object is present in the surroundings from the data. In a case where the detection unit **20** is an imaging camera, the detection unit **20** can detect objects such as workers, pedestrians, and obstacles within the detection range W1 by performing image recognition from the captured image in the detection range W1.

As shown in FIG. 1, the detection unit **20** of the monitoring device is attached to the rotating platform **12** without interposing the assembly component **13**. More specifically, the detection unit **20** is attached to a lower surface of the main frame **124** via a stay or the like and is disposed at a lower portion of the main frame **124** or below the main frame **124**. In addition, the main frame **124** may have a recessed portion at a lower portion thereof, and the detection unit **20** may be disposed in the recessed portion and be positioned above a bottom end of the main frame **124**.

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Moreover, the detection unit 20 is attached to a main body of the rotating platform 12 that is first attached to the lower traveling body 11. However, the attachment of the main body of the rotating platform 12 to the lower traveling body 11 is not performed on site or in its vicinity. The above main body that is first attached to the lower traveling body 11 is, for example, the main frame 124. Moreover, the detection unit 20 is disposed behind a turning bearing 112 of the rotating platform 12. In addition, the detection unit 20 is disposed at a position overlapping the mast 123 when viewed vertically from above. The mast 123 has two struts 123a, and a horizontal member 123b that connects the two struts to each other. The position overlapping the mast 123 when viewed from above may be a position overlapping the strut 123a or the horizontal member 123b when the mast 123 is at any angle from a horizontal angle to a vertical angle. The position where the mast 123 overlaps corresponds approximately to a center range in the left-right direction behind the center of the rotating platform 12.

Moreover, the detection unit 20 is disposed inside a turning radius RT (see FIG. 2) of the rotating platform 12. The turning radius RT means the trajectory of an end portion of a component that moves on the outermost side when the rotating platform 12 has turned, except for displaceable configurations such as the boom 133 and the mast 123. In a general crane, the turning radius corresponds to a rear end radius, and corresponds to the trajectory of a rear end portion of the counterweight 132 in a case where the counterweight 132 is attached.

As shown in FIGS. 1 and 3, the detection range W1 of the detection unit 20 extends rearward, leftward, rightward, upward, and downward. The detection range W1 overlaps a part of the counterweight 132, more specifically, overlaps a lower rear end portion of the counterweight 132. Therefore, the detection unit 20 can directly detect a portion that forms a turning radius (rear end radius) R1 of the rotating platform 12.

FIG. 6A is a side view showing a work machine of a comparative example. FIG. 6B is a plan view showing the work machine of the comparative example. In a case where the detection unit 20 is disposed above an upper rear end portion of the counterweight 132 as in a work machine 800 of the comparative example, unless the detection unit 20 is moved to another place before the counterweight 132 is attached, that is, when the work machine 800 is assembled or disassembled, there is a problem that surrounding monitoring cannot be performed. Moreover, since simply moving the detection unit 20 to another position lowers the accuracy of the position and angle of the detection unit 20, a problem occurs in that favorable surrounding monitoring is difficult.

Additionally, general mobile cranes are configured such that a desired lifting capacity can be selected from a plurality of levels of lifting capacity. The lifting capacity is switched by the number of attachment stages of the counterweights 132. The number of attachment stages of the counterweights 132 is detected by a weight detection device and notification is sent to the control unit of the work machine, and on the basis of this notification, the control unit sets the lifting capacity and determines various control parameters. When the detection unit 20 is disposed above the upper rear end portion of the counterweight 132, and when the lifting capacity has been changed, the number of stages of the counterweights 132 changes, and the height of the detection unit 20 changes. When the position of the detection unit 20 is constant, uniform monitoring processing is possible on the basis of the output of the detection unit 20. However, when the position of the detection unit 20 is not constant, it is

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necessary to prepare a plurality of kinds of setting data or programs for monitoring processing respectively adapted to a plurality of positions where the detection unit 20 is disposed. When the same monitoring processing is performed using one set data or program even when the position of the detection unit 20 changes, it is difficult to perform the monitoring processing that matches a difference in height.

Additionally, in recent mobile cranes, in order to reduce the size of the crane body portion and to improve the lifting capacity, the weight of the counterweight 132 is increased, and to that effect, the height of the counterweight 132 is often increased. When the detection unit 20 is disposed above the upper rear end portion of the counterweight 132 having an increased height, a blind spot H1 occurs near the turning radius RT as shown in FIGS. 6A and 6B.

Moreover, a fallen mast 123 may approach an upper portion of the counterweight 132. When the detection unit 20 is disposed in the center such that a single detection unit 20 can monitor a region that extends to the left and right, a risk occurs that the detection unit 20 and the mast 123 interfere with each other.

However, according to the work machine 1 of Embodiment 1, the detection unit 20 for the surrounding monitoring is attached to the rotating platform 12 without interposing the assembly component 13 that is lifted and attached by the heavy machine. Therefore, when the assembly component 13 is attached or detached, the surrounding monitoring can be performed using the detection unit 20 disposed at a predetermined position without changing the attachment position of the detection unit 20. When the assembly component 13 is lifted using the mast 123 and the rotating platform 12 is turned to move the assembly component 13, the surrounding monitoring can be performed on the basis of the detection of the detection unit 20 similar to that during normal work. Since the detection unit 20 is attached to the rotating platform 12, it is easy to monitor whether or not there is an abnormality in the surroundings when the rotating platform 12 turns. Since the detection unit 20 is not connected via the assembly component 13, a situation does not occur in which an error occurs in the position and angle of the detection unit 20 depending on the attachment state of the assembly component 13, and uniform surrounding monitoring that does not depend on the attachment state can be realized.

Moreover, according to the work machine 1 of Embodiment 1, the detection unit 20 is disposed on a lower surface of the main frame 124 or below the lower surface. Therefore, blind spots are less likely to occur behind the work machine 1, and it is possible to detect objects (workers, obstacles, or the like) that pass relatively below the counterweight 132 when the rotating platform 12 turns. In a case where the height of an object is low, when the rotating platform 12 turns, the object interferes with the rotating platform 12 or the rotating platform 12 (counterweight 132) passes above the object. Accordingly, a determination as to whether or not the object interferes with the rotating platform 12 can be performed on the basis of the detection result of the detection unit 20.

Moreover, according to the work machine 1 of Embodiment 1, the detection unit 20 is disposed so as to overlap the mast 123 when viewed vertically from above. Therefore, a single detection unit 20 can detect a region that extends to the left and right. Moreover, even when the detection unit 20 is at a position overlapping the mast 123, since the detection unit 20 is attached to the lower portion of the main frame 124, there is no risk of interference between the mast 123 and the detection unit 20.

Moreover, according to the work machine **1** of Embodiment 1, the detection unit **20** is disposed inside the turning radius RT. Therefore, on the basis of the detection result of the detection unit **20**, whether or not there is an abnormality from the inside of the turning radius RT to the vicinity and outside of the turning radius RT can be monitored. Moreover, according to the work machine **1** of Embodiment 1, since the counterweight **132** overlaps the detection range W1 of the detection unit **20**, the turning radius RT, that is, the rear end portion of the rotating platform **12** can be directly detected when the rotating platform **12** turns. Therefore, whether or not there is an abnormality in the vicinity of the turning radius RT can be monitored with higher accuracy.

Embodiment 2

FIG. 7 is a side view showing a work machine according to Embodiment 2 of the present invention when a first lifting capacity is set. FIG. 8 is a side view showing the work machine according to Embodiment 2 when a second lifting capacity lower than the first lifting capacity is set. A work machine **1A** according to Embodiment 2 is configured similar to the work machine **1** according to Embodiment 1 except that the attachment position of the detection unit **20** for the surrounding monitoring is different.

In Embodiment 2, the detection unit **20** is attached to a weight below the counterweight **132** in the uppermost stage mounted on the work machine body **10** when the second lifting capacity (for example, the lowest lifting capacity) lower than the first lifting capacity is set. In an example of FIGS. 7 and 8, the counterweights **132** mounted at the second lifting capacity are the base weight **132A** and two-stage first weights **132B**, which are also attached to the work machine body **10** even when other lifting capacities are set. In this case, the detection unit **20** may be attached to a lower portion of the base weight **132A**, the side surface or rear part of the base weight **132A** or of the first weight **132B**, or the like. Additionally, in the case of a configuration in which the first weight **132B** is suspended below the base weight **132A**, the detection unit **20** may be attached to a lower portion of the first weight **132B** positioned in the lowermost stage.

According to such an attachment position of the detection unit **20**, even when the work machine **1A** is set to have any lifting capacity, the detection unit **20** is disposed at a constant position and angle, and thus constant monitoring processing can always be performed during work.

Moreover, as shown in FIGS. 7 and 8, the detection unit **20** is attached to a lower portion of the counterweight **132**. Thus, a blind spot is less likely to occur behind the work machine **1A**, and objects (workers or obstacles) located below the counterweight **132** can also be detected when the rotating platform **12** turns. In a case where the height of an object is low, when the rotating platform **12** turns, the object interferes with the counterweight **132** or the counterweight **132** passes above the object. Accordingly, a determination as to whether or not the object interferes with the counterweight **132** can be performed on the basis of the detection result of the detection unit **20**.

Moreover, the detection unit **20** is disposed at a position overlapping the mast **123** when viewed from above. The position overlapping the mast **123** when viewed from above may be a position overlapping the strut **123a** or the horizontal member **123b** when the mast **123** is at any angle from a horizontal angle to a vertical angle. By virtue of such a disposition, a single detection unit **20** can detect a region that extends to the left and right. Moreover, even when the detection unit **20** is at a position overlapping the mast **123**,

since the detection unit **20** is attached to the lower portion of the counterweight **132**, there is no risk of interference between the mast **123** and the detection unit **20**.

Moreover, the detection unit **20** is disposed inside the turning radius RT of the rotating platform **12**. According to such a disposition, the monitoring from the inside of the turning radius RT to the vicinity and outside of the turning radius RT is possible. Moreover, the detection range W1 of the detection unit **20** overlaps the counterweight **132** (for example, a rear end of a lower surface of the base weight **132A**). According to such a disposition, the turning radius RT, that is, the rear end portion of the counterweight **132** can be directly detected when the rotating platform **12** turns, or the like, and whether or not there is an abnormality in the vicinity of the turning radius RT can be monitored with higher accuracy.

Moreover, a recessed portion U1 (see FIGS. 5A and 5B) is provided at the lower portion of the base weight **132A**, and the detection unit **20** is attached such that at least a part thereof enters the recessed portion U1. In a case where the detection unit **20** is attached to the side surface or rear part of the base weight **132A** or of the first weight **132B**, recessed portions may be provided in these spots of the weights **132A** and **132B**, and part or all of the detection unit **20** may be accommodated in the recessed portions. According to such an attachment structure, interference of the detection unit **20** attached to the base weight **132A** with other configurations or surrounding objects, or an increase in the turning radius can be suppressed.

As described above, according to the work machine **1A** of Embodiment 2, even when the number of stages of the counterweight **132** is changed to switch the setting of the lifting capacity, the position of the detection unit **20** does not change. Thus, uniform monitoring processing can be realized.

The respective embodiments of the present invention have been described above. However, the present invention is not limited to the above embodiments. For example, in the above embodiments, a crawler crane has been shown as the mobile crane, but the movement method of the mobile crane according to the present invention is not limited, cranes adopting any movement methods, such as truck cranes or wheel cranes, may be used, and the type of cranes may be any cranes such as tower cranes. Additionally, in the above embodiments, a crawler crane has been shown as the work machine that is assembled or disassembled at a work site, but the work machine according to the present invention is not limited to a crane, and any work machines such as hydraulic excavators, may be used as long as the work machines are assembled and disassembled at the work site. Additionally, in the above embodiments, a scanning range finder and an imaging camera have been used as an example of the detection unit. However, the detection unit may have any configuration as long as the detection unit acquires data that enables the detection of surrounding objects. In addition, the details illustrated in the embodiments can be appropriately changed without departing from the scope of the invention.

The present invention is applicable to a work machine and a mobile crane.

It should be understood that the invention is not limited to the above-described embodiment, but may be modified into various forms on the basis of the spirit of the invention. Additionally, the modifications are included in the scope of the invention.

What is claimed is:

1. A mobile crane that is assembled or disassembled at a work site, the mobile crane comprising:
a crane body; and
a counterweight that includes weights in a plurality of stages and that is attached to the crane body,
wherein a setting is capable of being changed to any one of a plurality of lifting capacities by changing the number of stages of the weights attached to the crane body,
the plurality of lifting capacities includes a first lifting capacity and a second lifting capacity that is a lower lifting capacity than the first lifting capacity,
the mobile crane further comprises a detection unit that monitors surroundings attached to the counterweight, and
the detection unit is attached to any one of the weights other than an uppermost stage of the weights attached when the second lifting capacity is set.
2. The mobile crane according to claim 1,
wherein the counterweight includes a base weight that supports another weight, and
the detection unit is attached to a lower portion of the base weight.
3. The mobile crane according to claim 1,
wherein the detection unit is disposed below the counterweight.

4. The mobile crane according to claim 1, further comprising:
a mast,
wherein the detection unit is disposed at a position being overlapped by the mast when viewed vertically from above.
5. The mobile crane according to claim 1,
wherein the counterweight includes a recessed portion that accommodates the detection unit.
6. The mobile crane according to claim 1,
wherein the detection unit is disposed inside a turning radius.
7. The mobile crane according to claim 1,
wherein a part of the counterweight is included in a detection range of the detection unit.
8. The mobile crane according to claim 1,
wherein the detection unit is disposed rearward of a frontmost portion of the counterweight.
9. The mobile crane according to claim 8,
wherein the detection unit is disposed at a position overlapping the counterweight when viewed vertically from below.
10. The mobile crane according to claim 8,
wherein the detection unit is disposed at a side part or a rear part of the counterweight.

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